Employee Handbook

Lumora Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Edition effective 1 April 2026

Sample document for a fictional company. For demonstration only.

1. Welcome and About This Handbook

1.1 Purpose

This handbook explains the policies, benefits and standards of conduct that apply to everyone who works at Lumora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. ("Lumora" or "the Company"). It is a guide, not a contract of employment. Where this handbook and your appointment letter differ, your appointment letter prevails. Where either differs from applicable Indian law, the law prevails.

1.2 Who This Handbook Applies To

The handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees, fixed-term contract employees and interns working from any Lumora office in India, unless a section says otherwise. Consultants engaged through third-party agencies are covered only by Chapter 8 (Code of Conduct), Chapter 9 (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) and Chapter 12 (Information Security).

1.3 Effective Date and Updates

This edition is effective from 1 April 2026 and replaces all earlier editions. The People Team reviews the handbook every year in March. Changes are announced by e-mail and published on PeopleDesk, the Company's HR portal, at least 15 days before they take effect, except where a change is required by law.

1.4 Getting Help

If something in this handbook is unclear, ask your manager or your HR Business Partner (HRBP) first. You can also raise a ticket on PeopleDesk or write to the HR helpdesk at hr-help@lumora.example. The helpdesk responds within 2 working days. Contact details for every team mentioned in this handbook are listed in Chapter 14.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Categories

- **Full-time employees** work the standard 40-hour week and are eligible for all benefits in this handbook.
- **Part-time employees** work between 20 and 30 hours a week. Leave entitlements are pro-rated to hours worked.
- **Fixed-term contract employees** are hired for a defined period of up to 24 months. They receive leave and health insurance but are not eligible for the annual performance bonus.
- **Interns** are engaged for 2 to 6 months and receive a monthly stipend. Interns receive 1 day of paid leave for each completed month of internship and are covered by group health insurance for themselves only.

2.2 Probation and Confirmation

All new full-time employees serve a probation period of 6 months from their date of joining. During probation, your manager will hold check-in conversations at the end of month 2 and month 4. If your performance is satisfactory, you will receive a confirmation letter within 15 days of completing probation. The Company may extend probation once, by up to 3 months, if more time is needed to assess performance. You will be told of any extension in writing before the original probation period ends.

2.3 Working Hours and Attendance

The standard working week is Monday to Friday, 40 hours, with a daily one-hour meal break that is not counted as working time. Lumora follows flexible hours: you may start work at any time between 8:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m., but you are expected to be available during core hours of 11:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Record your attendance on PeopleDesk every working day. Three or more unrecorded days in a calendar month are treated as unplanned absence and your manager will discuss them with you.

2.4 Notice Period

The notice period depends on your status and level:

Status / level	Notice period (either side)
During probation	15 days
Confirmed employees, levels L1 to L4	60 days
Confirmed employees, level L5 and above (managers)	90 days
Interns	7 days

Resignation and the rules for serving or buying out notice are covered in Chapter 13.

3. Leave Policy

3.1 Leave Year and General Rules

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Apply for all leave on PeopleDesk. Planned leave of more than 3 consecutive working days must be applied for at least 7 days in advance. Unplanned leave, such as sickness, must be reported to your manager by 10:00 a.m. on the first day of absence and applied for on PeopleDesk within 2 working days of returning. Weekends and public holidays that fall within a period of leave are not counted as leave days, except for maternity, adoption and sabbatical leave, which are counted in calendar weeks or months.

The table below summarises annual entitlements for full-time employees. Each type is explained in the sections that follow.

Leave type	Entitlement per year	Carry forward
Earned leave (EL)	18 working days	Up to 30 days
Casual leave (CL)	8 working days	None
Sick leave (SL)	10 working days	Up to 20 days
Public holidays	10 fixed + 2 optional	Not applicable
Paternity leave	10 working days per child	Not applicable
Maternity leave	26 weeks (first two children)	Not applicable

3.2 Earned Leave

Full-time employees earn 18 working days of earned leave (EL) a year, credited at 1.5 days at the end of each completed month of service. You can use earned leave from your date of joining, but you cannot take more than you have accrued. At the end of the leave year, up to 30 days of unused earned leave carry forward to the next year; any balance above 30 days lapses. On leaving the Company, you will be paid for up to 15 days of unused earned leave at your basic salary; any balance beyond 15 days is not paid out.

3.3 Casual Leave

Casual leave (CL) covers short personal needs. You receive 8 working days of casual leave on 1 January each year, pro-rated for employees who join during the year. Casual leave cannot be taken for more than 3 consecutive working days, cannot be combined with earned leave, and does not carry forward: any unused balance lapses on 31 December. Casual leave is not paid out on separation.

3.4 Sick Leave

You receive 10 working days of sick leave (SL) each year for your own illness or injury. A medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive working days. Unused sick leave carries forward up to a maximum accumulated balance of 20 days. Sick leave is not paid out on separation. If you have used all your sick leave, further absence due to illness is debited from earned leave and then treated as leave without pay.

3.5 Public Holidays

Lumora observes 10 fixed public holidays each year, published on PeopleDesk in December for the following year. In addition, you may choose 2 optional holidays from the list of restricted holidays to suit your own festivals or observances. Optional holidays must be selected on PeopleDesk at least 7 days in advance.

3.6 Compensatory Off

If your manager asks you to work on a weekend or public holiday, you earn one compensatory off (comp-off) day for each full day worked, or half a day for at least 4 hours worked. Comp-off must be approved by your manager on PeopleDesk before the work is done and must be used within 60 days of being earned, after which it lapses. Comp-off cannot be encashed.

3.7 Maternity Leave

Female employees who have worked for Lumora for at least 80 days in the 12 months before their expected date of delivery are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for each of their first two children, of which up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery. For a third or subsequent child, maternity leave is 12 weeks. In the case of a miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, 6 weeks of paid leave is available immediately following the event. Apply for maternity leave on PeopleDesk at least 8 weeks before your intended start date and attach a medical certificate stating the expected date of delivery.

After returning from maternity leave, you may request to work from home for up to 3 additional months where your role allows it, subject to your manager's approval. Lumora offices with 50 or more employees provide a creche facility or a creche allowance of Rs. 5,000 per month until the child turns 3.

3.8 Adoption and Surrogacy Leave

An employee who legally adopts a child below the age of 3 months, or a commissioning mother in a surrogacy arrangement, is entitled to 12 weeks of paid leave from the date the child is handed over. An employee who adopts a child aged 3 months or older is entitled to 6 weeks of paid leave.

3.9 Paternity Leave

Male employees and the non-birthing partner in any couple are entitled to 10 working days of paid paternity leave for each birth or adoption, up to a maximum of two children. Paternity leave must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption and can be taken in up to two blocks.

3.10 Bereavement Leave

In the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law), you are entitled to 5 working days of paid bereavement leave. For the death of a grandparent or grandchild, you are entitled to 2 working days. Bereavement leave should be taken within 30 days of the death and does not require supporting documents unless requested by HR.

3.11 Marriage Leave

Confirmed employees receive 3 working days of paid marriage leave for their own wedding, once during their employment with Lumora. It must be taken within 3 months of the wedding date.

3.12 Leave Without Pay and Sabbatical

When all applicable paid leave is exhausted, you may request leave without pay (LWP) for up to 30 days in a leave year, with the approval of your manager and HRBP. LWP beyond 30 days requires approval from the Head of People. Employees with at least 5 years of continuous service may apply for an unpaid sabbatical of 1 to 3 months for study, caregiving or personal projects. Health insurance continues during a sabbatical, but leave does not accrue.

4. Compensation and Payroll

4.1 Pay Date and Payslips

Salaries are paid by bank transfer on the last working day of each month. If the last working day is a bank holiday, salary is paid on the previous working day. Payslips are available on PeopleDesk by the 3rd of the following month. Report any payroll error to payroll@lumora.example within 30 days of the pay date.

4.2 Salary Structure

Your cost to company (CTC) is made up of basic salary (40% of fixed pay), house rent allowance (50% of basic salary), a flexible benefits component, the employer's provident fund contribution and, where applicable, a variable performance bonus. A breakdown is attached to your appointment letter and to each annual compensation letter.

4.3 Performance Reviews and Increments

Lumora's performance year runs from April to March. Annual performance reviews take place in April, and salary increments and promotions take effect from 1 July. Employees who joined after 1 January of the review year are reviewed but are not eligible for an increment until the next cycle. A mid-year check-in is held in October.

4.4 Performance Bonus

Full-time employees at levels L1 to L4 are eligible for an annual performance bonus with a target of up to 10% of fixed pay; employees at L5 and above have a target of up to 15%. The bonus depends on both Company and individual performance and is paid with the July salary. You must be on the Company's rolls on the payout date to receive the bonus, and employees serving notice are not eligible.

4.5 Salary Advance

Confirmed employees facing an emergency may request a salary advance of up to one month's net salary, once in any 12-month period. The advance is interest-free and is recovered in equal instalments over 6 months. Requests are submitted on PeopleDesk and approved by your HRBP and the Finance team.

5. Benefits

5.1 Group Health Insurance

Lumora provides group medical insurance from your date of joining. The policy is a family floater with a sum insured of Rs. 5,00,000 per year covering you, your spouse or registered partner and up to two children under 25 years of age. The premium for this cover is paid entirely by the Company. You may also add your parents or parents-in-law (but not both) under a separate parental cover of Rs. 3,00,000; the premium for parental cover is deducted from your salary.

The policy covers hospitalisation, day-care procedures and pre- and post-hospitalisation expenses for 30 and 60 days respectively. Maternity expenses are covered up to Rs. 75,000 per delivery, and there is no waiting period for pre-existing conditions. Cashless treatment is available at network hospitals; for other hospitals, submit a reimbursement claim to the insurer within 30 days of discharge. Dependants must be added within 30 days of joining or of a life event such as marriage or birth; otherwise they can only be added at the annual renewal in April.

5.2 Life and Accident Insurance

All full-time employees are covered by group term life insurance of 3 times annual fixed CTC and group personal accident insurance of 5 times annual fixed CTC. Both are fully paid by the Company. Please keep your nominee details up to date on PeopleDesk.

5.3 Provident Fund and Gratuity

Lumora contributes 12% of your basic salary to the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF), and an equal 12% is deducted from your salary as your contribution. Gratuity is payable under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 on separation after at least 5 years of continuous service, calculated as 15 days of last drawn basic salary for each completed year of service.

5.4 Wellness Benefits

- **Annual health check-up:** employees aged 30 and above can take one free comprehensive health check-up each year at a partner diagnostic centre.
- **Employee Assistance Programme (EAP):** you and your dependants can access confidential counselling with up to 6 free sessions per person per year. The Company does not learn who uses the EAP.
- **Fitness allowance:** Rs. 1,000 per month for gym memberships, sports or fitness apps, claimed through the flexible benefits plan.

5.5 Learning and Development

Each full-time employee has a learning budget of Rs. 40,000 per financial year for courses, conferences and certifications related to their role, with prior approval from their manager. Certification exam fees are reimbursed only if you pass the exam. If you leave Lumora within 12 months of a reimbursement above Rs. 25,000, you must repay the amount on a pro-rated basis.

5.6 Hybrid Work Allowance

Employees on a hybrid or remote arrangement receive an internet allowance of Rs. 1,500 per month, paid with salary. A one-time home office setup reimbursement of up to Rs. 10,000 is available for a chair or desk, claimed within 6 months of joining or of moving to a hybrid arrangement.

5.7 Employee Referral Programme

If you refer a candidate who is hired, you receive a referral bonus of Rs. 50,000 for engineering and data roles and Rs. 25,000 for all other roles. The bonus is paid after the new employee completes 90 days with Lumora and while you are still employed. Referrals of former Lumora employees, and referrals by hiring managers for their own open roles, are not eligible.

6. Work Arrangements

6.1 Hybrid Work

Lumora follows a hybrid model. Employees are expected to work from their assigned office at least 2 days a week, and Tuesdays and Thursdays are anchor days when teams meet in person. Teams may agree on additional office days. Employees in their probation period are expected to work from the office at least 3 days a week to help them settle in.

6.2 Remote Work

A fully remote arrangement requires approval from your department's Vice President and your HRBP, and is reviewed every 6 months. You may work from a city other than your base location for up to 30 working days in a calendar year with your manager's approval. Working from outside India, even temporarily, is not permitted without written approval from the People Team and Finance because of tax and data-protection obligations.

6.3 Overtime and Shifts

Employees in support roles who work rotational or night shifts receive a shift allowance of Rs. 300 per night shift worked between 10:00 p.m. and 6:00 a.m. The Company provides safe transport for employees whose shift starts or ends between 8:00 p.m. and 7:00 a.m. Regular work beyond 48 hours in a week requires approval from your manager and is compensated with comp-off as described in Section 3.6.

7. Travel and Expenses

7.1 Booking Business Travel

All business travel must be approved by your manager on PeopleDesk before you book. Book flights, trains and hotels through the Company's travel desk at travel@lumora.example at least 7 days in advance for domestic travel and 21 days in advance for international travel. For domestic trips over 500 km you may travel by economy-class flight; for shorter trips, travel by AC 2-tier train or Company-approved cab.

7.2 Hotel Limits and Per Diem

Hotel stays are reimbursed up to the following limits per night, including taxes. A daily allowance (per diem) covers meals and incidental expenses, and you do not need receipts for it.

Destination	Hotel limit per night	Per diem per day
Tier 1 cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru)	Rs. 6,000	Rs. 1,200
Tier 2 cities (Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai and others)	Rs. 4,500	Rs. 1,000
Other domestic locations	Rs. 3,000	Rs. 800
International travel	USD 180	USD 60

7.3 Submitting Expense Claims

Submit expense claims on PeopleDesk within 30 days of the expense or the end of your trip, with itemised receipts for every expense except per diem. Claims submitted after 30 days need approval from your department head, and claims older than 90 days will not be reimbursed. Any single claim above Rs. 5,000 needs approval from both your manager and the Finance team. Approved claims are reimbursed with the next salary payment.

7.4 Expenses That Are Not Reimbursed

- Alcohol, except at Company-approved client events.
- Traffic fines, parking fines and penalties of any kind.
- Personal entertainment, such as in-room movies, spa services or minibar charges.
- Upgrades to a higher class of travel or hotel without prior approval.
- Costs of family members or friends who travel with you.

8. Code of Conduct

8.1 Our Standards

Everyone at Lumora is expected to act with honesty, treat colleagues, clients and partners with respect, and comply with the law. You are responsible for reading this chapter and for raising concerns when you see behaviour that does not meet these standards.

8.2 Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when your personal interests could influence, or appear to influence, your work decisions. You must disclose any potential conflict to your manager and to compliance@lumora.example as soon as you become aware of it. Outside employment, freelancing or consulting (sometimes called moonlighting) requires prior written approval from your manager and HRBP, and is never allowed for a competitor, client or vendor of Lumora. Unpaid voluntary work and personal open-source projects that do not use Company resources or confidential information do not need approval.

8.3 Gifts and Hospitality

You may accept gifts or hospitality from clients, vendors or partners only if their value is Rs. 2,000 or less and they are not cash or cash equivalents such as gift cards. Any gift above Rs. 2,000 must be declared to Compliance within 7 days and may need to be returned or donated. Never accept a gift of any value from a vendor during an active procurement or tender process. Offering bribes or facilitation payments to anyone, including government officials, is strictly prohibited.

8.4 Confidentiality and Data Protection

You must protect the confidential information of Lumora, its clients and its employees, both during and after your employment. Share confidential information only with people who need it for their work, and never upload Company or client data to personal storage or to public AI tools that are not approved by the Information Security team.

8.5 Social Media

You may mention that you work at Lumora on personal social media, but you must not speak on behalf of the Company, share confidential information, or post content about clients without approval from the Communications team. Make it clear that your views are your own.

8.6 Dress Code

Lumora's dress code is business casual on regular office days. On Fridays, smart casual clothing is welcome. When meeting clients, follow the client's dress code or wear formal business attire.

8.7 Alcohol, Drugs and Smoking

Working under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs is prohibited. Alcohol may be served only at Company-approved events. Smoking and vaping are permitted only in designated areas outside office buildings.

9. Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

9.1 Our Commitment

Lumora has zero tolerance for sexual harassment. This policy follows the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, and the Company extends its protection to employees of all genders. It applies at the workplace, at offsite events, during business travel, and in online communication related to work.

9.2 Internal Committee

Each Lumora office has an Internal Committee (IC) chaired by a senior woman employee, with at least half of its members being women and one external member from an organisation working on women's rights. The names of IC members are displayed in every office and on PeopleDesk.

9.3 How to Raise a Complaint

A complaint should be made in writing to the Internal Committee at ic@lumora.example within 3 months of the incident, or of the last incident in a series. The IC may extend this time limit by a further 3 months if there were circumstances that prevented the complaint from being made earlier. If you need help writing the complaint, any IC member will assist you. You may also speak to your HRBP, who will connect you with the IC.

9.4 Inquiry and Outcome

The IC will complete its inquiry within 90 days of receiving a complaint, and the Company will act on its recommendations within 60 days of receiving the report. During the inquiry, the complainant may request interim measures such as a transfer or paid leave of up to 3 months. All proceedings are confidential. Retaliation against anyone who raises a complaint or takes part in an inquiry is itself misconduct and will lead to disciplinary action.

10. Grievances and Whistleblowing

10.1 Raising a Grievance

If you have a concern about your work, working conditions or treatment, first try to resolve it with your manager. If that does not work, or if the concern is about your manager, raise it with your HRBP or through a PeopleDesk grievance ticket. HR will acknowledge the grievance within 5 working days and aim to resolve it within 30 days. If you are not satisfied with the outcome, you may appeal to the Head of People within 15 days.

10.2 Whistleblower Policy

Report suspected fraud, bribery, financial misconduct, data breaches or serious violations of law or of this handbook through the Ethics Helpline at ethics@lumora.example or the confidential ethics portal on PeopleDesk, which accepts anonymous reports. Reports are reviewed by the Ethics Committee, which reports to the Audit Committee of the Board. Lumora protects whistleblowers who report in good faith from any retaliation, including dismissal, demotion or harassment.

11. Disciplinary Process

11.1 Misconduct

Misconduct is any breach of this handbook, your appointment letter or the law. Minor misconduct includes repeated late attendance or failing to record attendance. Serious misconduct includes harassment, theft, fraud, violence, disclosure of confidential information, and working under the influence of alcohol or drugs.

11.2 Steps in the Process

For most issues, the process is progressive: a verbal warning, then a written warning, then a final written warning. Performance concerns are addressed through a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) lasting 60 days, with fortnightly reviews. For alleged serious misconduct, the Company will issue a show-cause notice, and you must reply in writing within 3 working days. You may be suspended on full pay while an investigation is carried out. Serious misconduct, if proven, can result in termination without notice.

11.3 Your Rights

You will always be told the allegation against you, shown the evidence, and given a chance to respond before any decision is made. You may be accompanied by a colleague of your choice at any disciplinary hearing. You may appeal a disciplinary decision to the Head of People within 7 working days.

12. Information Security and IT

12.1 Acceptable Use

Company laptops, accounts and networks are provided for work. Limited personal use is acceptable if it does not affect your work or the security of Company systems. Do not install unapproved software, and do not use personal USB storage devices on Company laptops.

12.2 Passwords and Access

Use a unique password of at least 14 characters for your Lumora account, and keep multi-factor authentication (MFA) switched on for every Company system. Never share your password, including with IT staff.

12.3 Reporting Incidents and Lost Devices

Report a suspected security incident, such as a phishing e-mail you clicked on or data sent to the wrong person, to security@lumora.example within 1 hour of noticing it. Report a lost or stolen laptop or phone that has Company data to the IT helpdesk within 24 hours so it can be wiped remotely. You will not be penalised for reporting an honest mistake promptly.

13. Resignation and Separation

13.1 Resigning

To resign, submit your resignation on PeopleDesk and inform your manager. Your notice period, as set out in Section 2.4, starts on the day after your resignation is submitted. You may withdraw a resignation within 7 days of submitting it, with your manager's agreement.

13.2 Serving or Buying Out Notice

You are expected to serve your full notice period. The Company may, at its discretion, allow you to leave early by waiving part of the notice period or by accepting payment of basic salary in lieu of the unserved notice (a notice buyout). Earned leave cannot be used to shorten the notice period, except that up to 5 days of earned leave may be adjusted with your manager's approval. Leave taken during the notice period may extend your last working day.

13.3 Exit Process and Full and Final Settlement

Before your last working day, complete the handover agreed with your manager, return your laptop, ID card and any other Company property, and complete the exit interview with HR. Your full and final (F&F) settlement, including salary up to your last working day, encashment of eligible earned leave and any other dues, less any recoveries, will be paid within 45 days of your last working day. Your relieving letter and experience letter are issued on the day the F&F settlement is processed.

14. Contacts and Glossary

14.1 Key Contacts

Team	Contact	Use it for
HR helpdesk	hr-help@lumora.example, ext. 4040	General HR and policy questions
Payroll	payroll@lumora.example	Salary, payslips and tax
Travel desk	travel@lumora.example	Booking business travel
Compliance	compliance@lumora.example	Conflicts of interest and gifts
Internal Committee	ic@lumora.example	Sexual harassment complaints
Ethics Helpline	ethics@lumora.example	Whistleblowing, including anonymous reports
Information Security	security@lumora.example	Security incidents

14.2 Glossary

- **CTC**: cost to company, the total annual cost of your employment, including benefits.
- **HRBP**: HR Business Partner, the HR contact assigned to your department.
- **LWP**: leave without pay.
- **PeopleDesk**: Lumora's HR portal for leave, attendance, payslips, claims and tickets.
- **PIP**: Performance Improvement Plan.
- **F&F**: full and final settlement on leaving the Company.

This is a sample handbook for a fictional company, created to demonstrate an HR policy assistant. It does not describe any real organisation's policies and is not legal advice.